STUDENT ADVOCACY REPORT

Progress Report: Spring 2026

Covers January through April 2026

Summary

Since January 2026, student-led advocacy has pushed for stronger safety, trust, transparency, and student voice in SPASD. What began as a proposal to the Board led to meetings with district leaders, a new Student Senate at a district high school, and students taking part in leadership selection. Much is still in progress, and lasting change depends on follow-through.

Timeline

When	What happened
Jan 13	Student Safety & Trust Framework sent to the Board of Education
Jan 20	Board president responds; Board members affirm the importance of transparency and student voice
Mar 2	Meeting with district and school leaders on safety communication, consistency, and student voice
Mar–Apr	Follow-up on a Student Senate, mandated-reporting information, and a high school principal search
April	Student Senate application, election, and students invited to principal interviews
April	Bilingual student advocacy survey launched

What came out of it

- **Student Senate.** A new elected Senate at a district high school, with students from each grade plus club representatives, meeting weekly starting in 2026–27.
- **Leadership selection.** Students were invited onto a high school principal interview team.
- **Board response.** The Board pointed to steps already taken, like releasing an independent investigator's report and keeping an FAQ page, and committed to continued attention.
- **Communication.** District leaders agreed to share clearer information for students on mandated reporting: when outside agencies get involved and when parents are told.

Challenges

- Moving from informal feedback to real, structured involvement depends on district timelines.
- The Senate election ballot had errors and had to be reissued, which hurt trust in the process.
- One body can't carry all student voice. Other advisory and liaison roles are needed alongside it.

Recommendations

- Give the Student Senate clear rules, a schedule, and a defined role in decisions.
- Create more ways for students to give input: advisory groups, liaisons, and committee seats.
- Test election processes before launch and consider an application plus election model.
- Finish standard procedures for communicating after incidents, and update the community regularly.
- Track progress with regular reports, climate surveys, and 100-day check-ins.
- Bring student participation in leadership searches to every school level.

Independent and student-led. Written by Zackary Mark, a high school student in the Sun Prairie Area School District. Not an official SPASD document and does not speak for the district, its staff, or its Board. Shared in good faith; not meant to accuse any person. Contact: zackarymark160@gmail.com · Instagram @spasdstudentvoice